

Japan Electronic Components: Expert call: reconfirming sustained strength in nearline HDDs; we maintain Buy on TDK and HOYA

On July 7, we held a conference call with Techno Systems Research (TSR) to discuss the outlook for the HDD industry. Key points are as follows (unless otherwise noted, views are TSR's). **(1) Nearline HDDs:** 2026 TAM is expected to be 129 mn units (+4% yoy), of which nearline HDDs will account for 75.6 mn units (+12% yoy). The demand outlook is very strong, and robust production is expected to continue. **(2) Price trends:** The actions of HDD manufacturers in 2026 show a tendency to be more proactive in increasing capacity per unit (= average unit price increase) and raising prices on a same-product basis, rather than just increasing nearline HDD volumes/production capacity. Talk of LTAs heading toward 2030 has already emerged, and price increases are expected to continue. **(3) HDD components:** Bottlenecks for component/materials manufacturers are not as severe as they were at one point, but there are several materials that could become bottlenecks in the future. While ASP increases due to technological changes are possible, there have been no notable moves to raise prices on a same-product basis. **(4) HDD heads:** Outsourcing to TDK from WDC/STX (in-house heads) is expected to increase significantly from the April-June quarter (TDK has already disclosed guidance for a 40% increase in HDD head volumes in FY3/27, of which volumes for nearline HDDs are expected to increase 50%).

Bottom line: We reconfirmed the healthy and tight supply-demand situation for nearline HDDs. Component/materials manufacturers that (1) benefit from higher component counts, (2) benefit from ASP increases due to technological changes, and (3) can increase market share in nearline HDDs should strengthen their earnings growth potential. We maintain our Buy rating on TDK for HDD heads and suspensions, and HOYA for glass substrates.

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Exhibit 1: HDD Quarterly/Yearly Shipment and TAM

HDD Quarterly/Yearly Shipment & TAM										
mn units	2025				2026				2025	2026E
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	1Q	2QE	3QE	4QE		
Enterprise	0.82	0.81	0.73	0.79	0.76	0.63	0.64	0.60	3.15	2.62
NL	14.61	16.47	18.14	18.40	18.66	18.70	19.09	19.15	67.62	75.60
3.5" ATA	7.57	7.85	7.17	8.35	8.27	7.76	7.50	7.30	30.94	30.83
2.5" Mobile	5.70	5.27	5.57	5.50	5.32	5.16	4.85	4.73	22.04	20.06
Total	28.70	30.40	31.61	33.04	33.01	32.25	32.08	31.78	123.75	129.11
Rev (mn \$)	4,717	5,416	5,898	6,260	6,981	7,465	7,901	8,131	22,291	30,478
ASP	164.4	178.2	186.6	189.5	211.5	231.5	246.3	255.9	180.1	236.0

Source: Techno Systems Research, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: HDD Quarterly/Yearly Production

HDD Quarterly/Yearly Production										
mn units	2025				2026				2025	2026E
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	1Q	2QE	3QE	4QE		
Enterprise	0.95	0.85	0.79	0.85	0.69	0.60	0.73	0.66	3.44	2.68
NL	17.32	18.37	18.96	20.12	20.77	20.97	21.28	21.35	74.77	84.37
3.5" ATA	7.12	6.85	7.30	7.24	7.29	6.81	6.78	6.73	28.51	27.61
2.5" Mobile	5.62	5.61	5.96	5.63	5.14	5.38	4.88	4.80	22.82	20.20
Total	31.01	31.68	33.01	33.84	33.89	33.76	33.67	33.54	129.54	134.86

Source: Techno Systems Research, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - TDK

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of ¥4,600. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - HOYA

Valuation methodology: Our 12-month target price of ¥33,000 is based on a sum-of-the-parts valuation methodology (FY26-27E EV/EBITDA-based, implies FY3/28E P/E of 35X and P/B of 11X), using different multiples for each of HOYA's two main segments – life care (FY3/27-3/28E EV/EBITDA of 15X/13X) and IT (FY3/27-FY3/28E EV/EBITDA of 35X/28X).

Key risks: Intensifying competition in core businesses, a weakening of demand, and large-scale capex or M&A deals.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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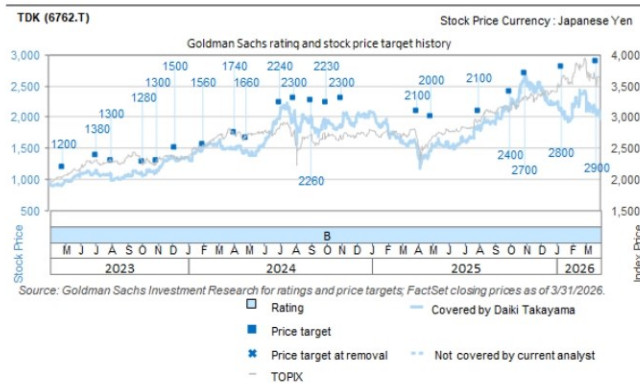
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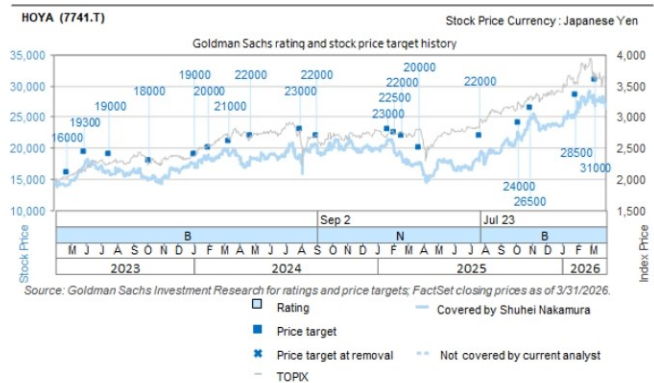
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Target price history table(s)

HOYA (7741.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-May-26	33,000	27,080
30-Apr-26	32,000	29,100
09-Mar-26	31,000	26,765
30-Jan-26	28,500	25,870
31-Oct-25	26,500	25,085
08-Oct-25	24,000	22,155
23-Jul-25	22,000	18,590
24-Mar-25	20,000	17,490
18-Feb-25	22,000	19,040
03-Feb-25	22,500	19,625
22-Jan-25	23,000	21,500
02-Sep-24	22,000	20,760
01-Aug-24	23,000	18,680
24-Apr-24	22,000	18,685
13-Mar-24	21,000	18,925
01-Feb-24	20,000	18,550
04-Jan-24	19,000	16,995
05-Oct-23	18,000	15,135
19-Jul-23	19,000	16,350

TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052
02-Aug-23	6,500	1,089

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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